Topic: IT Strategy and Change proposal for an organization

This is a Group Assignment worth 35%
Deadline: End of Week 12

Objective(s)
You will work in teams to act as internal consultants for a fictional organization. Your goal is to identify key business challenges or opportunities and propose a strategic IT-enabled change initiative that increases organizational value. Your proposal will cover strategic planning, stakeholder engagement, governance, ethical and security concerns, and data-driven justifications.

Learning outcomes
By the end of this assignment, students will be able to:

- LO1: Understand issues relating to ethics and professional responsibility in the IT profession and be able to analyse and resolve ethical dilemmas
- LO2: Understand the issues relating to software testing, data security, data quality, and quality assurance in the IT industry and learn methods to solve those issues using IT project management.
- LO3: Analyse wider issues and problems concerning professional practice in IT and learn current trends in human resource management in the IT industry.
- LO4: Understand the use of IT in different industries and evaluate the impact of information technology on individuals and organizations within our globalized world.
- LO5: Demonstrate an ability to construct effective written and oral communication appropriate to IT practitioners using skills including conflict resolution, contract negotiation team formation, leadership, and team dynamics.
- LO6: Apply investigative research methods, models, and tools to IT professional practice; identify and critique changing information on the area of interest; and interpret the potential validity of results.

Final Deliverables [Summing up to 35% of the final grade]

- A consolidated group report that merges all your weekly tasks into a comprehensive proposal. This will be worth 30% of the total grade.
- Peer Evaluation via SparkPlus - *All members must complete a peer review. Marks may be adjusted based on contributions. This will be done twice in the semester, one in the middle before the midterm break, and the other at the end of the semester, right after the submission of the assignment.* This will be worth 5% of the total grade.

Indicative Assessment Criteria – *Final rubrics can be found on the assignment submission page on Canvas*.

- Clarity and depth of business problem/opportunity identification
- Strategic alignment of IT initiative with business goals
- Justification and research quality
- Stakeholder and communication planning
- Consideration of governance, ethics, security, and risk

- Overall report coherence, professionalism, and presentation
- Peer review accuracy and engagement

Timeline

- Group formation starts in Week 1 & 2.
- Group formation is finalized in Week 3.
- Each group finishes the weekly template by the provided soft deadline.
- Assignment is completed and submitted at the end of Week 12.

Weekly expectations

Note: The templates are the minimum/expected amount of information that needs to be presented for that week. We expect you to exceed the template and create an exceptional report which goes beyond the given structure whilst following the rules/requirements.

Week	Description
3	Create a fictional organization. Something that has the potential to become a start-up or something as simple as being inspired by an existing company. The business and IT context (existing IT infrastructure, culture, etc.) would be researched, and a business model would be produced through this template. Template: **"Getting Started", "AW2 - About the Organisation", "Business Model Canvas"**
3	Defining the business governance structure. Identification of the core business challenge/opportunity. Followed by a draft proposal on how IT can help. Template: **"AW 3 – Governance and Proposal"**
4	Selection of a suitable Project Management methodology for the IT implementation project and outlining a simple timeline based on the lifecycle chosen. Template: **"AW 4 – PMP and Timeline"**
5	Mapping the stakeholders involved with the project. Drafting communication and engagement plans alongside the identification of communication risks and its management. Template: **"AW 5 – Stakeholder mapping and Communication plan"**
6	Justification of the IT implementation project, strategy, choices (systems/tools) and time and resource estimation of the project. Template: **"AW6 - Justification, Tools, Time, and Resource Estimation"**

7	Defining the IT governance structure, roles and responsibilities, compliances, and oversight. Template: **"AW7 - IT Governance and Oversight"**
8	Building a change management plan to address resistance, the training regiment, and cultural impacts. Template: **"AW8 - Change Management Plan"**
9	Designing QA measures and testing plans for the implementation and roll out. Template: **"AW9 - QA & Testing Plans"**
10	Conducting risk assessments and drafting a security and privacy policy. Checking for compliances with Industry norms. Template: **"AW10 - Risk, Security & Privacy"**
11	Exploring ethical issues (bias, data ethics, transparency). A reflection of individual (as in individual team member) and overall company (generic) regarding ethics. Template: **"AW11 - Ethics and Responsibility"**
12	Connecting the templates and linking the solution to data-driven KPI and explaining how to monitor for continuous improvement Template: **"AW12 - Monitoring, KPIs and Continuous Improvement"**

Instructions

- It is expected that the students will follow the Expectations and the soft deadlines.
- The provided templates ensure all students start from the same baseline and cover the minimum requirements for a good grade. However, assessment will also consider the depth of research and additional sections students include. Groups demonstrating exceptional work may receive a certificate of recognition.
- Any text in *red italics* needs to be deleted from the templates. They are just to provide more information to you as supporting text and should not be part of your report.
- You must choose a combination of industry and sector from the provided list and this needs to be unique in your own tutorial class.
- You must have the template contents completed before you deviate and provide extra content for your report for each week.
- You must fill out the reference list (in APA7 format) as provided in the **"Reference List template"** on Canvas.
- The provided templates span across 12 weeks, aligning with the lecture content to guide your work progressively. There will be a **single submission at the end of Week 12**, which will serve as a **compilation of all the completed templates**. You may refer to the following structure to understand how these templates will integrate into the final submission.

List of Industries and Sectors

Industry		Sector
Government	Software Development	Public Services
Public education	IT Services and Consulting	Professional/Corporate services
Public healthcare	Cybersecurity	Healthcare
Management consulting	E-Commerce	Manufacturing
Legal services	Fashion and Apparel	Information Technology
Accounting	Grocery chains	Retail
Pharmaceuticals	Banking	Financial Services
Biotechnology	Insurance	Transportation and Logistics
Hospitals/Clinics	Fintech	Energy and Utilities
Automotive	Airlines	Media and Entertainment
Electronics	Shipping and Freight	
Heavy Machinery	Urban Mobility	
Oil and Gas	Renewable Energy	
Electricity Distribution	Film and TV production	
Digital Publishing	Gaming	

Key Understandings

- There is a difference between Industry and Sector
  - Sector refers to a broad classification of the economy.
  - Industry refers to a more specific group of companies within a sector.
- There are mainly 4 different types of Geographical presences
  - Local - Operates in a specific city or region.
  - National - Operates across multiple cities or states within one country.
  - International - Has a presence in a few selected foreign countries
  - Global - Operates across multiple continents with a truly global footprint.

How would your report look at the end

- Cover Page
- Declaration
- Table of Contents
- About the Organization
- Governance and Proposal
- PMP and Timeline
- Stakeholder mapping and Communication Plan
- Justification, Tools, Time, and Resource Estimation
- IT Governance and Oversight
- Change Management Plan
- QA & Testing Plans
- Risk, Security & Privacy
- Ethics & Responsibility
- Monitoring, KPIs & Continuous Improvement

- Conclusion
- Reference List
- Appendix
    - Business Model Canvas
    - Team Profile
    - Personal Reflection
    - Others